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SOLVED

PREVIOUS YEAR QUESTIONS

OBJECTIVE & DESCRIPTIVE

Motivation – Part 1

Introductory Note

This document contains the following 2 Parts –

Part I – We have discussed the Objective Questions asked in previous years.

Part II – We have discussed the Descriptive Questions asked in previous years.

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Part I

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Guidelines for Part I

Under this part, you will find the memory based previous year's questions **(Objective part)** that were asked in RBI, SEBI, and PFRDA. It includes 3 sections:

Section A – Under this section, you will find the memory based previous year's questions that were asked in RBI, SEBI, and PFRDA. This section will enable you to test your knowledge based on different concepts and for your comfort, we have segregated the questions according to the different examinations. The questions have been arranged in the following manner:

1. **RBI Grade B -** Here, you will find all the previous year's questions, which were asked in phase 2 of the RBI Grade B exam, starting from 2016 onwards.
2. **SEBI Grade A** - Here, you will find all the previous year's questions, which were asked in phase 2 of the RBI Grade B exam, starting from 2018 onwards.
3. **PFRDA Grade A** - Here, you will find all the previous year's questions, which were asked in phase 2 of the RBI Grade B exam, starting from 2021 onwards.

If there is no question in this document on any exam for a particular year or years, it means no question was asked for that exam in that year(s) or the exam itself was not conducted in that year.

Section B - In this section, you will find the answer key for all the questions, and it will enable you to check your marks and understand your performance accordingly.

Section C – This section contains a detailed explanation of every question, and herein you will be able to understand the concept in the best holistic manner possible.

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Part I

Section A

Questions asked in Phase 2 of the RBI Grade B exam, from 2016 onwards

Question 1 – Identify the framework developed by Frederick Herzberg, that suggests, there are certain factors in the workplace that can cause job satisfaction and a separate set of factors can cause dissatisfaction. Which theory are we talking about? **RBI Grade B - Phase 2 - 2017**

A. Equity Theory
B. Two-Factor Theory
C. Self-Efficacy Theory
D. Competency Theory
E. None of the above

Question 2 – In the field of motivation, which of the following is not a hygiene factor as per Two Factor Theory? **RBI Grade B - Phase 2 - 2018**

A. Supervision
B. Recognition
C. Salary
D. Job Security
E. None of the above

Question 3 – There are various theories of motivation given by different people from time to time, one such theory is ERG theory, in the same regard, what does R for in the ERG theory of motivation? **RBI Grade B - Phase 2 2018**

A. Relation
B. Relatedness
C. Relative
D. Recycle
E. None of the above

Question 4 – In the general parlance of motivation, Alderfer has condensed 5 needs of Maslow's theory into 3 categories of human needs in which of the following theory? **RBI Grade B - Phase 2 - 2019**

A. Expectancy Theory
B. Hygiene Theory
C. Reduction Theory
D. ERG Theory
E. None of the above

Read the following paragraph and answer the question that follows

Ram is currently working in the XYZ company, and he is employed in the company for a long period of time. Another company that is very much in the news is ABC company. ABC company is operating on a small scale, and it has huge growth potential. Ram got fascinated by the growth prospects of the ABC company and thereby he decided to join the ABC company. ABC company offered a highly reputed job position to Ram and thereby Ram accepted the job offer.

Soon after joining the ABC company, the colleagues of his ABC company were not happy with Ram, because Ram was directly recruited from outside, and straight away, he was promoted to a senior position.

Moreover, after some time Ram complained about poor working conditions of the Air Conditioner (AC), Desk, and chair in the office, but the office authorities didn't pay any attention to Ram's complaint and after getting frustrated Ram decided to leave ABC company and he decided to start his own venture.

Question 5 – As Ram complained about the poor working conditions of the Air conditioners, desk, and chair. As per Clayton Herzberg's theory, which of the following need of Ram is not met? **RBI Grade B - Phase 2 – 2022**

A. Satisfier needs.
B. Hygiene needs
C. Motivating needs
D. Growth needs
E. None of the above

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Read the following paragraph and answer the question that follows-

Ram is currently working in the XYZ company, and he is employed in company for a long period of time. Another company that is very much in the news is ABC company. ABC company is operating on small scale, and it has huge growth potential. Ram got fascinated by the growth prospectus of the ABC company and thereby he decided to join the ABC company. ABC company offered a high reputed job position to Ram and thereby Ram accepted the job offer.

Soon after joining the ABC company, the colleagues of his ABC company was not happy with Ram, because Ram was directly recruited from outside and straight away, he was promoted to the senior most position.

Moreover, after some time Ram complained about poor working conditions of the Air Conditioner (AC), Desk and chair in the office, but the office authorities didn't pay any attention to the Ram's complaint and after getting frustrated Ram decided to leave ABC company and he decided to start his own venture.

Question 6 – As Ram shifted from XYZ company to the ABC company, this change of job can be explained by which of the following Theory of motivation? **RBI Grade B - Phase 2 – 2022**

A. Existence needs – Alderfer's Theory of motivation
B. Achievement needs – David McClelland's Theory of motivation
C. Belonginess Needs – Maslow's Theory of Motivation
D. Growth Needs – Alderfer's Theory of Motivation
E. None of the above

Read the following paragraph and answer the question that follows.

Ram is currently working in the XYZ company, and he is employed in the company for a long period of time. Another company that is very much in the news is ABC company. ABC company is operating on a small scale, and it has huge growth potential. Ram got fascinated by the growth prospects of the ABC company and thereby he decided to join the ABC company. ABC company offered a high reputed job position to Ram and thereby Ram accepted the job offer.

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Moreover, after some time Ram complained about poor working conditions of the Air Conditioner (AC), Desk and chair in the office, but the office authorities didn't pay any attention to the Ram's complain and after getting frustrated Ram decided to leave ABC company and he decided to start his own venture.

Question 7 – As Ram is very talented employee, what could ABC company could have provided to Ram, so that Ram can be retained back in the Organization? **RBI Grade B - Phase 2 – 2022**

A. Interpersonal relationships
B. Autonomy
C. Higher pay
D. Social Environment
E. None of the above

Read the following paragraph and answer the question that follows.

Motivation is the driving force that compels individuals to act and pursue goals, stemming from internal desires or external incentives. It energizes behavior, directing efforts toward achieving objectives and satisfying needs, influencing performance and satisfaction in various aspects of life.

Two eminent contributors to the field of motivation are Abraham Maslow and David McClelland. They have identified specific workplace motivational needs. In this context, David McClelland proposed _____"X"_____ motivating elements, while Maslow presented the hierarchical structure of the need pyramid. Their seminal work has significantly advanced the understanding of human motivation in organizational settings.

Q.8) Identify "X" from the following given options**. RBI Grade B - Phase 2 – 2023**

A. 1
B. 2
C. 3
D. 4
E. None of the above

Read the following paragraph and answer the question that follows.

Motivation is the driving force that compels individuals to act and pursue goals, stemming from internal desires or external incentives. It energizes behavior, directing efforts toward achieving objectives and satisfying needs, influencing performance and satisfaction in various aspects of life.

Two eminent contributors to the field of motivation are Abraham Maslow and David McClelland. They have identified specific workplace motivational needs. In this context, David McClelland proposed _____"X"_____ motivating elements, while Maslow presented the hierarchical structure of the need pyramid. Their seminal work has significantly advanced the understanding of human motivation in organizational settings.

Q.9) With regards of the above paragraph, if an employee is currently at the Physiological needs, then what will be the highest level as per Maslow motivational theory. **RBI Grade B - Phase 2 – 2023**

A. Safety Needs
B. Security Needs
C. Belonginess Needs
D. Self Esteem Needs
E. Self-Actualization Needs

Read the following paragraph and answer the question that follows.

Motivation is the driving force that compels individuals to act and pursue goals, stemming from internal desires or external incentives. It energizes behavior, directing efforts toward achieving objectives and satisfying needs, influencing performance and satisfaction in various aspects of life.

Two eminent contributors to the field of motivation are Abraham Maslow and David McClelland. They have identified specific workplace motivational needs. In this context, David McClelland proposed _____"X"_____ motivating elements, while Maslow presented the hierarchical structure of the need pyramid. Their seminal work has significantly advanced the understanding of human motivation in organizational settings.

Q.10) Managers' perceptions of employees can vary significantly. Some may view certain employees as lazy and disliking work, while others may perceive them as enthusiastic and enjoying their job. Identify the theory of motivation which explains such different Managers' perceptions of employees **RBI Grade B - Phase 2 – 2023**

A. Adam Equity Theory
B. Vroom Expectancy Theory
C. Theory X and Theory Y
D. ERG theory
E. None of the above

Questions asked in Phase 1 and Phase 2 of the SEBI Grade A exam, starting from 2018 onwards.

Question 1 – Motivation is defined as the process that initiates, guides, and maintains goal-oriented behaviors. In the same regard, which of the following is not need as per Maslow's Theory**? SEBI Grade A - Phase 2 – 2018**

A. Esteem Need
B. Self-Actualization Need
C. Physical Need
D. Physiological Need
E. None of the above

Question 2 – There are various techniques which a leader or a manager might use, in the same regard, to identify the performance approach wherein rewards and punishment are used by a manager to get the work done by an employee. **SEBI Grade A - Phase 1 – 2020**

A. MBO
A. Carrot and Stick Approach
B. Transformational Approach
C. Eclectic Motivation
D. None of the above

Question 3 - Who propounded Theory Z in management? **SEBI Grade A - Phase 2 – 2024**
A. Peter Drucker
B. Abraham Maslow
C. William Ouchi
D. Elton Mayo
E. Henry Fayol

Questions asked in Phase 1 and Phase 2 of the PFRDA Grade A exam, starting from 2021 onwards.

Question 1 – Identify the Motivation theory in which a person aims at gaining new knowledge, has a desire for beauty, and wants to help others, etc. is known as _____**? PFRDA Grade A – Phase 1 – 2021**

A. Maslow's Extended Theory of Motivation
B. Alderfer's ERG Theory
C. Herzberg's Two-Factor Theory
D. Adam's Equity Theory
E. Vroom's Expectancy Theory

Section B

Answer Key

RBI Grade B questions

Question Number	Answer

Question 1	Option B
Question 2	Option B
Question 3	Option B
Question 4	Option D
Question 5	Option B
Question 6	Option D
Question 7	Option D
Question 8	Option C
Question 9	Option E
Question 10	Option C

SEBI Grade A questions

Question Number	Answer
Question 1	Option C
Question 2	Option B
Question 3	Option C

PFRDA Grade A questions

Question Number	Answer
Question 1	Option A

Section C

Explanation
RBI Grade B questions

Question 1 – Identify the framework developed by Frederick Herzberg, that suggests, there are certain factors in the workplace that can cause job satisfaction and a separate set of factors can cause dissatisfaction. Which theory are we talking about? **RBI Grade B- Phase 2 - 2017**

A. Equity Theory
B. Two-Factor Theory
C. Self-Efficacy Theory
D. Competency Theory
E. None of the above

Answer – Option B

Explanation -
The question is pretty much straightforward, as per Frederick Herzberg there **are two factors that decide the motivation level or status of a particular human being**.

The first factor which decides the motivation level is the **satisfiers** or job content factors and the **second one is the Hygiene** factors or job context factors. These two factors combinedly decide **whether a person is satisfied or dissatisfied.**

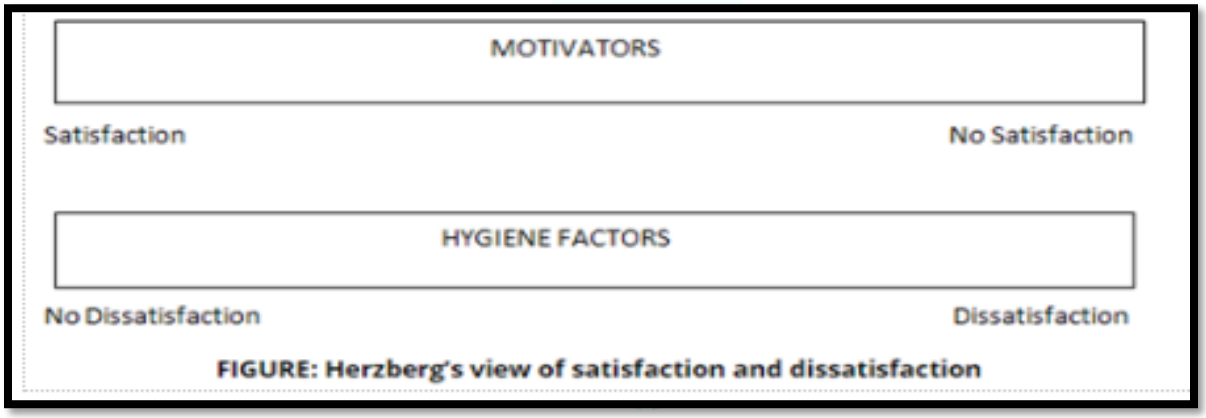

FIGURE: Herzberg's view of satisfaction and dissatisfaction

SATISFACTION (MOTIVATION) - These factors are inherent to work. These factors motivate the employees for superior performance. These factors are called satisfiers. These are factors involved in performing the job. Employees find these factors intrinsically rewarding. The motivators symbolized the psychological needs that were perceived as an additional benefit**.**

Motivational factors include:

- Achievement
- Recognition
- Work itself
- Responsibility
- Advancement
- Growth and Promotion

DISSATISFACTION (HYGIENE) - Hygiene factors also known as maintenance factors are not intrinsic part of the job but are related to the conditions under which job is performed. Hygiene factors are those factors which

when adequate/reasonable in a job, pacify the employees and do not make them dissatisfied but do not motivate them. These factors are extrinsic to work. The hygiene factors symbolized the physiological needs which the individuals wanted and expected to be fulfilled.

Hygiene factors include:

- Company policy
- Administrative Policies
- Supervision
- Salary
- Interpersonal relations
- Working conditions

Question 2 – In the field of motivation, which of the following is not a hygiene factor as per Two Factor Theory? **RBI Grade B- Phase 2 - 2018**

A. Supervision
B. Recognition
C. Salary
D. Job Security
E. None of the above

Answer – Option B

Explanation –

The given question is **very conceptual in nature** and if you carefully notice, **only recognition** is the factor that will affect the employee intrinsically, the rest all the options will affect the employee extrinsically.

SATISFACTION (MOTIVATION): According to Herzberg, hygiene factors cannot be regarded as motivators. The motivational factors yield positive satisfaction. These factors are inherent to work. Motivational factors include:

- Achievement
- **Recognition**
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Question 3 – There are various theories of motivation given by different people from time to time, one such theory is ERG theory, in the same regard, what does R for in the ERG theory of motivation**? RBI Grade B - Phase 2 2018**

A. Relation
B. Relatedness
C. Relative
D. Recycle
E. None of the above

Answer – Option B

Clayton P. Alderfer proposed ERG theory in 1969 which condenses Maslow's five human needs into three categories- **Existence, Relatedness, and Growth. ERG is short for Existence needs, Relatedness Needs and Growth need**

- **Existence refers to our concern with basic material existence requirements**; what Maslow called physiological and safety needs.
- **Relatedness refers to the desire we have for maintaining interpersonal relationships**; like Maslow's social/love need,
- **Growth refers to an intrinsic desire for personal developmen**t, Maslow's esteem needs, and self-actualization.

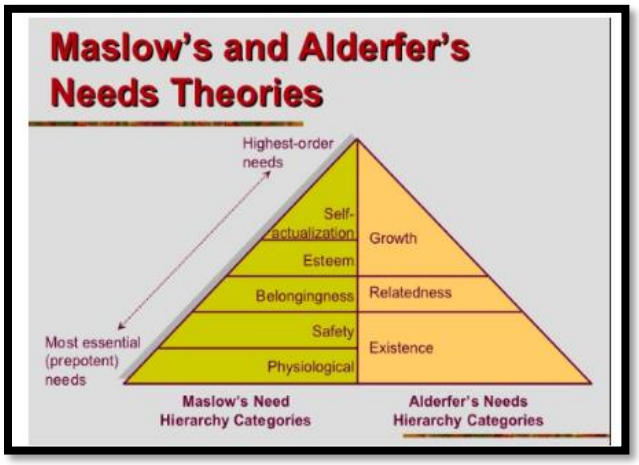
Question 4 – In the general parlance of motivation, Alderfer has condensed the 5 needs of Maslow's theory into 3 categories of human needs in which of the following theory? **RBI Grade B- Phase 2 - 2019**

A. Expectancy Theory
B. Hygiene Theory
C. Reduction Theory
D. ERG Theory
E. None of the above

Answer – Option D

Explanation –

Clayton P. Alderfer proposed **ERG theory** in 1969 which **condenses Maslow's five human needs into three categories: Existence, Relatedness, and Growth.**



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Read the following paragraph and answer the question that follows

Ram is currently working in the XYZ company, and he is employed in company for a long period of time. Another company which is very much in the news is ABC company. ABC company is operating on small scale, and it has huge growth potential. Ram got fascinated by the growth prospectus of the ABC company and thereby he decided to join the ABC company. ABC company offered a high reputed job position to Ram and thereby Ram accepted the job offer.

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Moreover, after some time Ram complained about poor working conditions of the Air Conditioner (AC), Desk and chair in the office, but the office authorities didn't pay any attention to the Ram's complain and after getting frustrated Ram decided to leave ABC company and he decided to start his own venture.

Question 5 – As Ram complained about poor working conditions of the Air conditioners, desk, and chair. As per Clayton Herzberg's theory, which of the following need of Ram is not met ? RBI Grade B - Phase 2 – 2022

A. Satisfiers needs
B. Hygiene needs
C. Motivating needs
D. Growth needs

E. None of the above

Answer – Option B

Explanation –

It's clearly given that Ram is not happy with **the poor performance of ACs, desks and chairs, which means Ram is not happy with the working conditions and as per Herzberg's Two Factor Theory, working conditions are an example of Hygiene factors.**

Herzberg's Two Factor Theory is also known as the Motivation Hygiene Theory. It states two different facets of motivation, the first being 'hygiene' factors or job context. The second factor is 'satisfiers or job content, i.e., the intrinsic qualities of the job.

1. **SATISFACTION (MOTIVATION):** According to Herzberg, the hygiene factors cannot be regarded as motivators. The motivational factors yield positive satisfaction. These factors are inherent to work. These factors motivate the employees for a superior performance. These factors are called satisfiers. These are factors involved in performing the job. Employees find these factors intrinsically rewarding. The motivators symbolized the psychological needs that were perceived as an additional benefit. Motivational factors include:
   - Achievement
   - Recognition
   - Work itself
   - Responsibility
   - Advancement
   - Growth and Promotion

2. **DISSATISFACTION (HYGIENE):** Hygiene factors also known as maintenance factors are not intrinsic part of the job but are related to conditions under which job is performed. Hygiene factors are those factors which when adequate/reasonable in a job, pacify the employees and do not make them dissatisfied but do not motivate them. But if these factors are absent / if these factors are non-existent at workplace, then they lead to dissatisfaction. These factors are extrinsic to work. Hygiene factors are also called as dissatisfiers or maintenance factors as they are required to avoid dissatisfaction. These factors describe the job environment/scenario. The hygiene factors symbolized the physiological needs which the individuals wanted and expected to be fulfilled. Hygiene factors include:
   - Company policy
   - Administrative policies
   - Supervision
   - Salary
   - Interpersonal relations
   - Working conditions
   - Job Security

Herzberg also says that it is not only these factors but the personality of the individual also

Read the following paragraph and answer the question that follows

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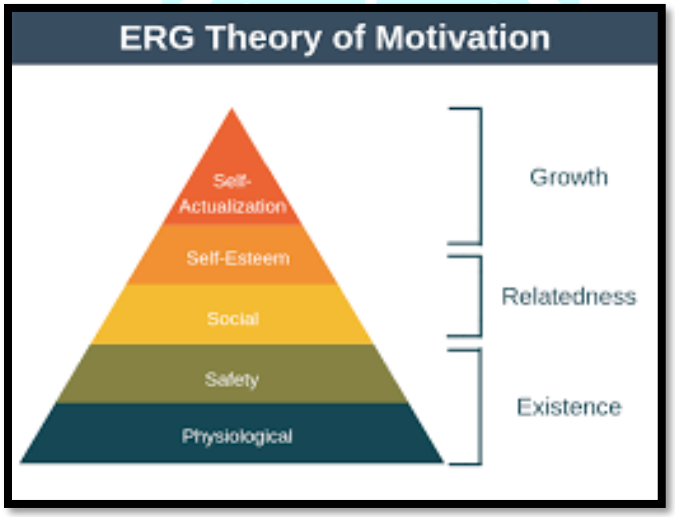
Question 6 – As Ram shifted from XYZ company to the ABC company, this change of job can be explained by which of the following Theory of motivation? RBI Grade B - Phase 2 – 2022

A. Existence needs – Alderfer's Theory of motivation
B. Achievement needs – David McClelland's Theory of motivation
C. Belonginess Needs – Maslow's Theory of Motivation
D. Growth Needs - Alderfer Theory of motivation
E. None of the above

Answer – Option (D)

Explanation-
It's clearly given the question that ABC company is having a huge growth potential, which could have attracted Ram and t**hereby Growth needs of Alderfer Theory of motivation, clearly explains the movement of Ram from XYZ company to the ABC company.**



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Question 7 – As Ram is very talented employee, what could ABC company could have provided to Ram, so that Ram can be retained back in the Organization? **RBI Grade B - Phase 2 – 2022**

A. Interpersonal relationships
B. Autonomy
C. Higher pay
D. Social Environment
E. None of the above

Answer – Option D

Explanation –

There is a very clear and straightforward mention that present employees of ABC Ltd, were not happy with Ram, which means that Ram was not able to **have good interpersonal relations with fellow team members, however, the presence of the word social environment would be a good option to choose, because social environment will include interpersonal relations. Therefore, the correct answer for this question should be option D, which is social environment.**

Please be informed that Autonomy will not be the correct answer because autonomy majorly deals with the freedom to do the task and the key words related to Autonomy are also missing.

Read the following paragraph and answer the question that follows.

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Two eminent contributors to the field of motivation are Abraham Maslow and David McClelland. They have identified specific workplace motivational needs. In this context, David McClelland proposed _____"X"_____ motivating elements, while Maslow presented the hierarchical structure of the need pyramid. Their seminal work has significantly advanced the understanding of human motivation in organizational settings.

Q.8) Identify "X" from the following given options**.** **RBI Grade B - Phase 2 – 2023**

A. 1
B. 2
C. 3
D. 4
E. None of the above

Answer – Option C

Explanation –

David McClelland identified three learned or acquired needs, **often referred to as "manifest needs." These needs are:**

- Achievement Need (nAch): This is the desire to excel, accomplish challenging goals, and experience a sense of accomplishment and success.
- Affiliation Need (nAff): This need pertains to the desire for social interaction, companionship, and positive relationships with others.
- Power Need (nPow): The power need involves the desire to influence, control, and have an impact on others or one's environment.

Read the following paragraph and answer the question that follows.

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Two eminent contributors to the field of motivation are Abraham Maslow and David McClelland. They have identified specific workplace motivational needs. In this context, David McClelland proposed _____"X"_____ motivating elements, while Maslow presented the hierarchical structure of the need pyramid. Their seminal work has significantly advanced the understanding of human motivation in organizational settings.

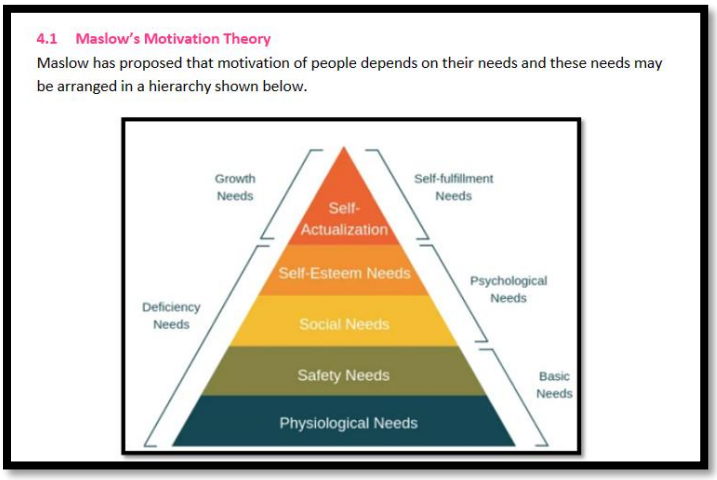
Q.9) With regards of the above paragraph, if an employee is currently at the Physiological needs, then what will be the highest level as per Maslow motivational theory**. RBI Grade B - Phase 2 – 2023**

A. Safety Needs
B. Security Needs
C. Belonginess Needs
D. Self Esteem Needs
E. Self-Actualization Needs

Answer – Option E

Explanation –

If an employee's physiological needs are met, the highest level they can aspire to as per Maslow's motivational theory is self-actualization. At this stage, they seek personal growth, fulfillment, and the realization of their full potential, focusing on creativity and self-development.



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Q.10) Managers' perceptions of employees can vary significantly. Some may view certain employees as lazy and disliking work, while others may perceive them as enthusiastic and enjoying their job. Identify the theory of motivation which explains such different Managers' perceptions of employees **RBI Grade B - Phase 2 – 2023**

A. Adam Equity Theory
B. Vroom Expectancy Theory
C. Theory X and Theory Y
D. ERG theory
E. None of the above

Answer – Option C

Explanation –

Theory X and Theory Y are contrasting management theories proposed by Douglas McGregor. Theory X assumes employees are inherently lazy, dislike work, and need constant supervision, relying on punishments and rewards. In contrast, Theory Y suggests that employees are intrinsically motivated, enjoy work, and can be self-directed when given autonomy and responsibility. These theories influence managerial approaches, with Theory Y fostering a more participative and empowering leadership style

4.6 McGregor's Theory X and Theory Y

Douglas McGregor developed the theory that there are two basic management behavior types, Theory X managers and Theory Y managers, each of which has a quite different set of assumptions about others.

Theory X Assumptions:

1. People have an inherent dislike of work and will try to avoid it at all costs
2. People need to be coerced, controlled, and threatened to work hard
3. People are not ambitious and dislike responsibility, preferring to be directed
4. Above all else, people want security

Theory X managers are authoritarian and controlling, using threat and punishment to coerce people into working hard. The **carrot and stick approach** to motivation is followed. People are shown carrot (rewards) to get the work done and if they are not able to meet the targets then they are punished. They tend not to produce elevated levels of performance from their teams.

Explanation
SEBI Grade A questions

Question 1 – Motivation is defined as the process that initiates, guides, and maintains goal-oriented behaviors. In the same regard, which of the following is not need as per Maslow's Theory? **SEBI Grade A - Phase 2 - 2018**

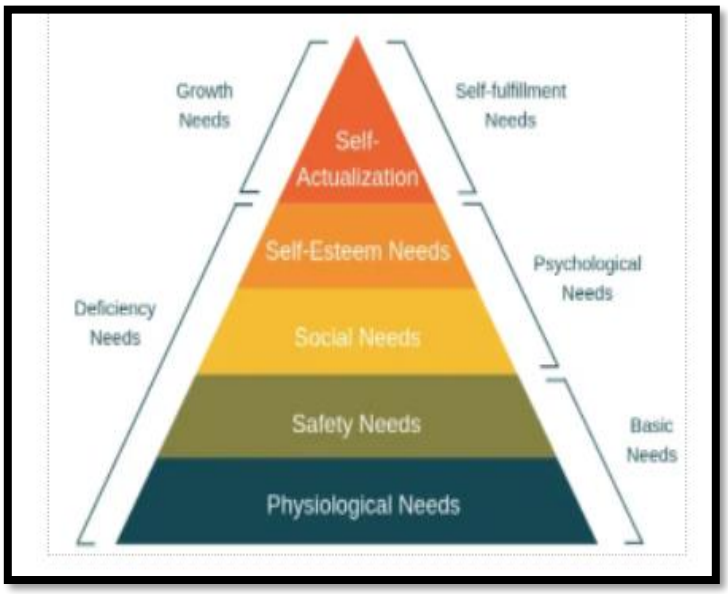
A. Esteem Need
B. Self-Actualization Need
C. Physical Need
D. Physiological Need
E. None of the above

Answer – Option C

Explanation -

The question is very straightforward, Maslow has proposed that motivation of people depends on their needs and these needs may be arranged in a hierarchy shown below -

- **Physiological needs:** These primary needs are created in an individual by nature. Needs of air, water, food, defecation, etc. are such needs.
- **Safety needs (Security needs):** After fulfilling physiological needs an individual wants physical safety and well-being (emotional security, financial security).
- **Needs of belongingness:** Having the above two needs been fulfilled an individual wants a sense of belonging to someone or a group. He wants love, affection, and friendship from his fellow beings.
- **Esteem needs:** All humans have a need to feel respected; this includes the need to have self-esteem and self-respect. Esteem presents the typical human desire to be accepted and valued by others.



- **Needs of self-actualization:** An individual comes to recognize his strengths and weaknesses fully before coming to this last level of needs.

Question 2 – There are various techniques that a leader or a manager might use, in the same regard, to identify the performance approach wherein rewards and punishment are used by a manager to get the work done by an employee. **SEBI Grade A - Phase 1 - 2020**

A. MBO
B. Carrot and Stick Approach
C. Transformational Approach
D. Eclectic Motivation
E. None of the above

Answer – Option B

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Explanation – Here, **the key words will be rewards and punishment** which are used by the manager to get desired results, **wherein carrot refers to the rewards and stick refer to the punishment**.

The Carrot and the Stick approach to motivation, makes use of rewards and penalties in order to induce desired behaviour. **The philosophy of this approach comes from the old story that the best way to make a donkey move is to put a carrot out in front of it or jab it with a stick from behind.**

Carrot refers to rewards, which are offered or promised to individuals to act in the desired way; while stick refers to punishments which are to be inflicted on individuals, **for not acting in the desired way. In away, carrot refers to positive motivation; and stick refers to negative motivation.**

Question 3. - Who propounded Theory Z in management? **SEBI Grade A - Phase 2 - 2024**

A. Peter Drucker
B. Abraham Maslow
C. William Ouchi
D. Elton Mayo
E. Henry Fayol

Answer: C

Explanation:

- Theory Z was propounded by **William Ouchi**, a renowned management professor, in his book *"Theory Z: How American Business Can Meet the Japanese Challenge."*
- The theory focuses on **increasing employee loyal**ty to the company by providing a job for life and **focusing** on the **well-being** of the employee, both on and off the job.
- It combines elements of American and Japanese management styles. **Hence, statement C is correct and so option C is correct.**
- **Peter Drucker** is famous for his contributions to management practices, but **Theory Z** is not one of them. **Hence**, **option A is incorrect**.
- **Abraham Maslow** is well known for his hierarchy of needs, which is unrelated to **Theory Z**. **Hence**, **option B is incorrect**.
- **Elton Mayo**, known for the Hawthorne Studies, did not develop **Theory Z**. **Hence**, **option D is incorrect**.
- **Henry Fayol** is recognized for administrative management theories, not for **Theory Z**. **Hence**, **option E is incorrect**.

Hence, option C is the correct answer.

Explanation

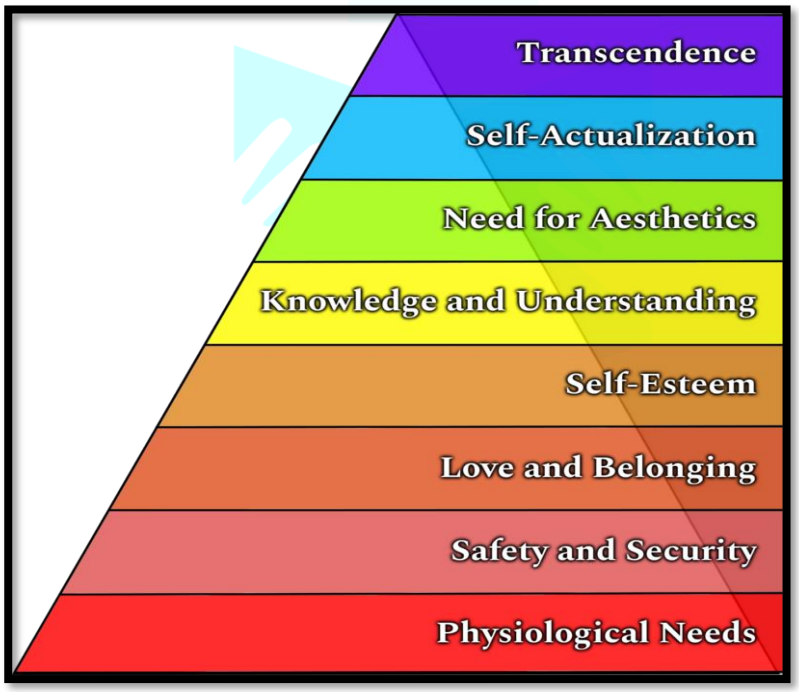
PFRDA Grade A questions

Question 1 – Identify the Motivation theory in which a person aims at gaining new knowledge, has desire for beauty, and wants to help others etc. is known as _____? **PFRDA Grade A – Phase 1 – 2021**

A. Maslow's Extended Theory of Motivation
B. Alderfer's ERG Theory
C. Herzberg's Two-Factor Theory
D. Adam's Equity Theory
E. Vroom's Expectancy Theory

Answer – Option A

Explanation –
Since at least the 1970s there have been debates and discussions on whether Maslow identified all of the motivating stages that drive humans. Some have argued that there **should be more levels to the Hierarchy of Needs**. Most seem to agree that there should **be three new additions to the Hierarchy of Needs.**



The three new additions to Maslow's original Hierarchy of Needs model are:

(a) Knowledge and Understanding (Cognitive Needs)
(b) Need for Aesthetics
(c) Transcendence

- **Knowledge and Understanding (Cognitive Needs):** This the need to learn and would clearly be a growth need. **People have a desire to explore** and learn new things or understand the world around them. The inability to meet the cognitive needs may make it difficult to reach Self-Actualization. Self-Actualization is about personally growing and is a more complex form of gaining knowledge and understanding.

- **Need for Aesthetics**: This is about the desire for beauty and pleasing surroundings in our life. Through the chaos, we seek order and balance. We want to appreciate the things we find beautiful; you may stop to smell the roses.

- **Transcendence:** Transcendence is **the desire to move beyond ourselves**. In the expanded hierarchy it is placed after Self-Actualization, making it the highest level in the hierarchy. People seeking to fulfill their **Transcendent needs may be motivated by helping others or becoming wholly driven by factors that do not personally impact them**. They are so confident in their lower-level needs being met satisfactorily that they worry about the needs of others.

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Part II

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Guidelines for Part II

Under this part, you will find the memory based previous year's questions **(Descriptive part)** that were asked in RBI.

RBI started including a Descriptive component in 2021 after a gap of 6 years (after 2014). Between 2007-2014, the RBI exam had a descriptive portion but from 2014 to 2020, there was no descriptive component in RBI. Hence,

1. We shall cover all previous year questions asked in **RBI Grade B Exam from 2021 and between 2007-2014**
2. **For questions asked in RBI Grade B Exam between 2007-2014, the following points must be noted -**
   - **I.** Some questions from previous years might not be covered in any of the chapters since they might not belong to the current syllabus. The syllabus earlier was different from the current syllabus.
   - **II.** Some questions from previous years might not be covered as they are related to current affairs of that year, which is not relevant now.
   - **III.** Moreover, some chapters have a lot of previous year questions, in those chapters, we have given complete answers to some questions and for the rest of the questions, the answer outline is given.

If there is no question in this document on any exam for a particular year or years, it means no question was asked for that exam in that year(s) or the exam itself was not conducted in that year.

Other Points to be Noted.

1. The answers given here are not to be crammed. They are not given from the perspective of being perfect answers. No answer is a perfect answer. If we ask 500 people to write answers to these questions, then we will get 500 different answers and we cannot decide which one is the perfect answer. The answers given here are to help you guide towards the approach to answering.
2. The answers written here may exceed the word limit in some cases. But that is done intentionally so that you understand it better and, in the exam, you can further summarize that information to achieve the desired word limit.
3. In certain answers, the content/points written may not be covered in the notes/videos. But that is also done to make you realize that we cannot simply be bookish in writing answers, rather some content/points need to be written from our understanding of things. **This is called the application part.**

Questions asked in Phase 2 of the RBI Grade B since 2021 and between 2007-2014

There was no descriptive question asked from the chapter "Motivation".

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